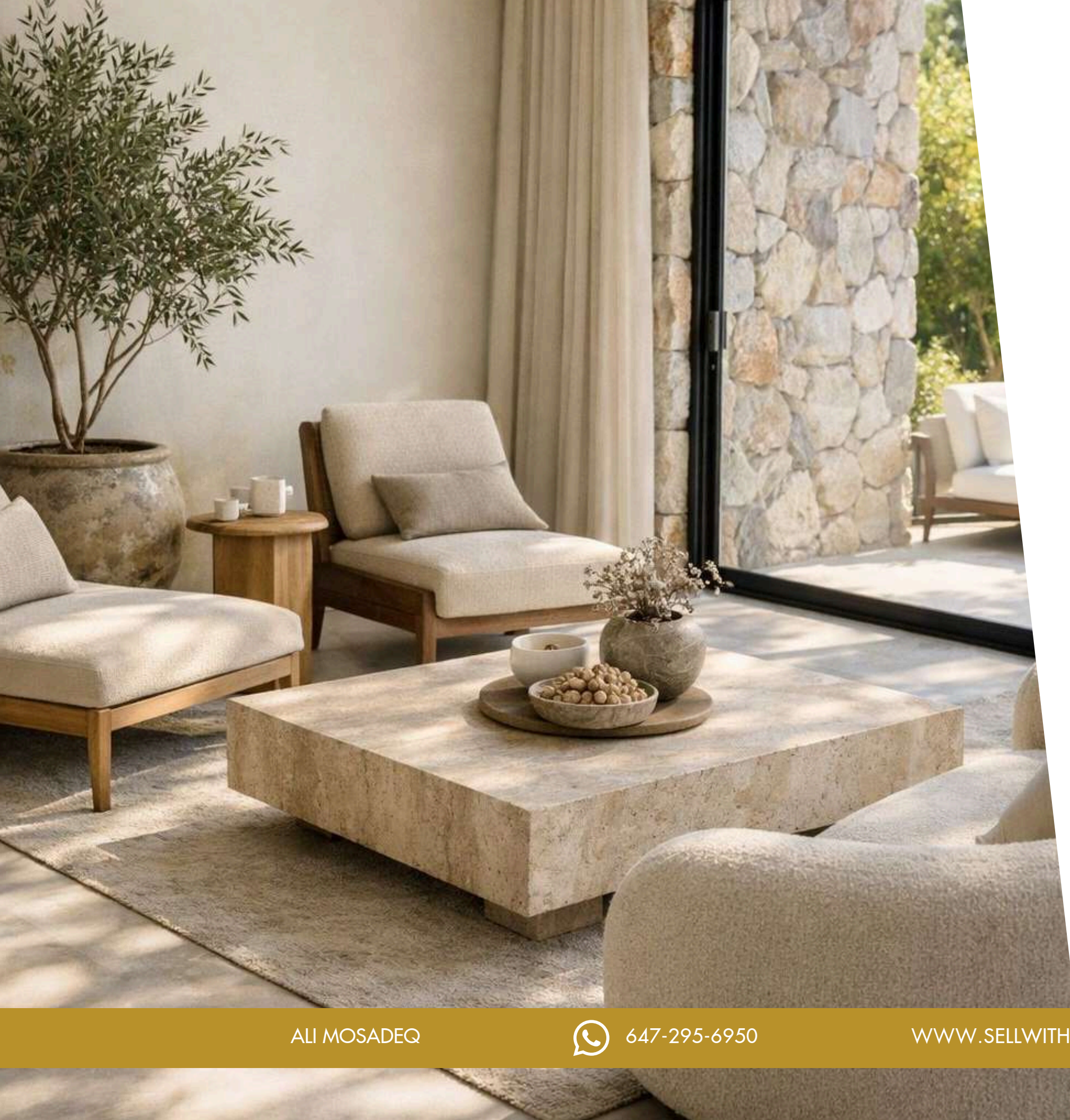




THE HOME BUYING CHECKLIST

Getting Ready to Buy a Home?

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Whether this is your first home purchase or your tenth, there are a lot of moving parts when it comes to buying a new house. You should feel in control and confident throughout this process.

We've compiled this checklist for you so nothing gets missed! (Although, if you follow Step 1 correctly, you should have all the guidance you need!)

Here are the pillars:

- BUILDING A FOUNDATION
- THE FINANCIALS
- FINDING YOUR NEW HOME
- INSURING YOUR HOME
- THE HOME STRETCH



BUILDING A FOUNDATION

STEP 1: FIND A REALTOR

- Interview a few Realtors and see if their personality matches your needs/wants. You want to “click”!
- Qualifications your Realtor should have:
 - Local market knowledge
 - Good reviews or testimonials
 - Financial Knowledge – they can walk you through the numbers!
 - Works full time in the industry
 - Great time management and communication skills (ie. did they show up on time & prepared? Do they communicate with you in a way that you understand and feel comfortable with?)
 - Network connections (Effective Realtors rely on their relationships. Do they work with other agents regularly?)
 - They should ask about your Housing Goals and future vision
- Sign the necessary representation documents to get started

STEP 2: KNOW YOUR FINANCIALS

- Maintain great credit
- Pay off as much debt as you can before proceeding
- Your lender will be pulling your credit in the future as a part of the pre-approval process so don't worry about that just yet
- Compile and save any important financial documents, including:
 - 2 months worth of pay stubs & bank statements
 - 2 years of tax returns & NOA's or T4's (T4A's and T1's if you're self-employed/incorporated)

STEP 3: FIND A MORTGAGE BROKER

- Find a mortgage broker you can trust for advice and guidance, or ask your Realtor for a referral
- Compare different lenders to understand the benefits and advantages of working with each. (Something as simple as a lower rate or term can save you thousands of dollars over the life of the loan.)
- Make sure to tell YOUR BROKER not to pull your credit until you're fully committed to working with them
- If your credit isn't where you want it to be, work on creating a plan with your broker





THE FINANCIALS

STEP 4: ESTABLISH A BUDGET

- Determine your downpayment amount and start process so that the money is accessible and not tied up elsewhere
- Saving up 20% of a home's purchase price as a down payment is often suggested, but can be hard to do in high-priced markets (If saving up 20% isn't feasible, work with your lender to create the best plan for your needs)
- Consider other costs associated with moving (ie. closing costs, moving costs, renovation costs, new furniture, etc)
- Remember that just because you're approved for a certain amount doesn't mean that you have to spend that amount. Work with your lender and Realtor to establish a price point and monthly payment that you will be comfortable with

STEP 5: GET PRE-APPROVED FOR A MORTGAGE

- Ask the lender if you qualify for any special loans or incentives, such as FTHB, FHSA, HBP (RRSP), New Housing HST Rebate, etc.
- Get Pre-Approved; this gives you, your Realtor, and the lender an estimate of how much you can afford based off of your credit score and past financial documents
- Work with your mortgage broker and Realtor to determine if your file should be underwritten before submitting any offers. This will help to avoid any potential disappointments or delays during the transaction

FINDING YOUR NEW HOME

STEP 6: THE FUN PART

- Your mortgage pre-approval will help guide you to the type of property and community you can afford
- Discuss your home buying wish list with your Realtor. Make sure to include:
 - Must haves: bed/bath number, garage, size, etc.
 - Nice to haves: finished basement, pool, smart home capabilities, etc.
 - Things to avoid: pools, busy streets, highways, etc.
- Bring along your pre-approval and broker contact information so you can discuss budget and have your Realtor connect with your chosen broker
- Select different neighborhoods you might want to live in based on your budget
- Have all decision makers involved, either in person or virtually

STEP 7: FIND A HOME

- Keep your "Must Haves" Checklist in mind
- Keep a journal or guide of the different houses you're interested in
- Take plenty of pictures to look back at
- Stay within your price range!
- Bring a snack, hand sanitizer and shoes that are easy to slip on and off
- Provide your Realtor with ANY feedback regarding the properties that you view. Both positive and negative feedback can be very helpful for a Realtor to find exactly what you want

STEP 8: MAKE AN OFFER

- Work with your Realtor to establish a strategy to get the most from your offer and have the best chance of it getting accepted
- Sign the offer and any additional documents!





INSURING YOUR HOME

STEP 9: DO YOUR DUE DILIGENCE

- Find a reputable and thorough home inspector, if you need suggestions ask your Realtor
 - A good home inspector will help to ensure that you don't end up in a "money pit," for example, a property with lots of electricity, plumbing or foundation issues
 - An inspector will also report any issues found with the home that will allow you to ask for repairs during negotiations
- If work is needed to be done on the property, strategize with your Realtor to submit a request for repairs or offer adjustment
- Review disclosures and paperwork with your Realtor
- If you will be making any additions or construction to the property, such as adding a pool or a guest house, check with the city building department to ensure zoning allows for those upgrades

STEP 10: ARRANGE FOR HOMEOWNER'S INSURANCE

- Search for a homeowner's insurance policy with great coverage at a reasonable cost
- Some lenders require a year's worth of homeowner's insurance up front before approving a mortgage

THE HOME STRETCH

STEP 11: FINALIZE FINANCING WITH YOUR LENDER

- The lender will order an appraisal on the home to verify that the market value supports the purchase price
- Double check that your interest rates and mortgage payments are what you agreed upon

STEP 12: FINAL WALKTHROUGH OF THE HOME

- Go through the house with your Realtor to double check everything you agreed upon in your offer is present
- Ensure that any repairs that were agreed upon in the transaction were completed.
- If repairs are difficult to visually inspect, call back your home inspector or a specialist to ensure the repairs were completed correctly
- Turn on all lights and appliances to make sure that they still are in good working order

STEP 13: CLOSING THE DEAL

- Set a meeting date with your lawyer the week of your closing
- Bring everything you might need:
 - Form of identification
 - Any additional payment you may need
 - Sign the mortgage documents!

STEP 14: MOVE IN!

- Pack a “move-in” bag with the essentials for that first day while you unpack (ie. toilet paper, snacks, cleaning supplies, etc)
- Arrange to get the keys to your new home
- **Celebrate! *You now own your new home!***





HAVE ANY QUESTIONS?

USING OUR MOVE-UP BLUEPRINT, WE STRIVE TO MAKE THE PROCESS AS FUN AND EXCITING AS POSSIBLE AS WE GUIDE YOU THROUGH THE TRANSACTION FROM START TO FINISH.

LET US KNOW HOW WE CAN HELP YOU FIND YOUR DREAM HOME!

LET'S CHAT!

[CLICK HERE TO BOOK A CALL](#)



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